

Convention on Prohibitions or Restrictions on the Use of Certain Conventional Weapons Which May Be Deemed to Be Excessively Injurious or to Have Indiscriminate Effects

20 October 2025

English only

Group of Governmental Experts on Emerging Technologies
in the Area of Lethal Autonomous Weapons Systems
Geneva, 3-7 March and 1-5 September 2025

Agenda item 5

Further consider and formulate, by consensus, a set of elements of an instrument, without prejudging its nature, and other possible measures to address emerging technologies in the area of lethal autonomous weapon systems, taking into account the example of existing Protocols within the Convention, proposals presented by High Contracting Parties and other options related to the normative and operational framework on emerging technologies in the area of lethal autonomous weapon systems, building upon the recommendations and conclusions of the Group, and bringing in expertise on legal, military, and technological aspects

Chair's summary – Second 2025 session of the GGE on LAWS

Submitted by the Chairperson*

The Chairperson submits this summary, under his sole authority, with the intention of capturing his understanding of the work carried out during the second 2025 session of the Group of Governmental Experts on Lethal Autonomous Weapons Systems and to maintain an informal record of proceedings to help inform the future work of the Group.

I. Background and procedural aspects

1. The second 2025 session of the Group of Governmental Experts (GGE) on emerging technologies in the area of lethal autonomous weapons systems (LAWS) (hereinafter “the Group”) was opened by the Chairperson, H.E. Mr. Robert in den Bosch of the Kingdom of the Netherlands, on Monday 1 September 2025. It was closed on Friday 5 September 2025.
2. The Group's mandate was decided by the 2023 Meeting of the High Contracting Parties to the Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons (CCW). The Meeting decided as follows: “That the work of the open-ended Group of Governmental Experts related to emerging technologies in the area of lethal autonomous weapon systems established by Decision 1 of the Fifth Review Conference as contained in document CCW/CONF.V/10, adhering to the agreed recommendations contained in document CCW/CONF.V/2, is to continue, to strengthen the Convention. In the context of the objectives and purpose of the Convention, the Group is to further consider and formulate, by consensus, a set of elements of an instrument, without prejudging its nature, and other possible measures to address emerging technologies in the area of lethal autonomous weapon systems, taking into account the example of existing Protocols within the Convention, proposals presented by High Contracting Parties and other options related to the normative and operational framework on emerging technologies in the area of lethal autonomous weapon systems, building upon the

* The present document is being issued without formal editing.



recommendations and conclusions of the Group, and bringing in expertise on legal, military, and technological aspects.” (CCW/MSP/2023/7, paragraph 20).

3. The Group’s mandate was recalled by the 2024 Meeting of the High Contracting Parties to the CCW (CCW/MSP/2024/7, paragraph 23).

4. It was recalled that the agenda, contained in document CCW/GGE.1/2025/1, was adopted by the Group during the first 2025 session.

5. The Chairperson recalled the work undertaken since the last formal session of the Group¹ (3-7 March 2025), including the circulation of a revised version of the rolling text on 12 May 2025, which had been elaborated on the basis of exchanges during the first 2025 session of the Group. The Chairperson also briefed the Group on the virtual informal consultations with High Contracting Parties on the rolling text, held on 4 and 12 June 2025, in the lead-up to the second 2025 session. The Chairperson also noted that two virtual informal consultations had been held to facilitate effective preparation for the second session, one on 17 June 2025 for observers to exchange views on the rolling text and another one on 28 May 2025 for both High Contracting Parties and observers to discuss the Chair’s background paper on context-appropriate human judgment and control and the critical functions of LAWS.

6. The Chairperson highlighted that 6 delegates were attending this session with the support of the CCW Sponsorship Programme.

7. The session gathered 85 High Contracting Parties, 1 Signatory State, 8 Observer States, 1 organization with observer status in the United Nations, 1 United Nations entity, the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), 9 academic organizations and 26 non-governmental organizations. Participants held substantive, technical and detailed discussions, the summary of which is contained in section II below.

II. Overview of discussions

8. As proposed by the Chairperson, the Group agreed to refrain from holding a general exchange of views. Rather, the Group engaged directly in substantive discussions. The Group had before it the rolling text (version as circulated on 12 May 2025),² building on the discussions held during the first 2025 session of the Group. The rolling text is structured along 5 boxes addressing various elements.

A. Box I

9. In Box I, the Chairperson’s rolling text (version 12 May 2025 as corrected on 20 August 2025) proposed the following elements:

1. *Within the scope of the application of the CCW, a lethal autonomous weapon system can be characterized as an integrated combination of one or more weapons and technological components, that can select and engage a target, without intervention by a human user in the execution of these tasks.*
2. *For the purposes of these elements of an instrument, lethal refers to the capacity to cause death to a person. The fact that a LAWS can be used in circumstances that do not result in death, such as to damage or destroy objects or to cause injury, does not exclude it from this characterization.*
3. *The above description is without prejudice to any future understanding and the potential modification of this characterization, as well as the possible exclusion of certain types of systems.*

10. The Chairperson presented the most significant changes introduced in Box I of the rolling text since the last session. In particular, the Chairperson highlighted the decision to

¹ Chair’s summary – First 2025 session of the GGE on LAWS, CCW/GGE.1/2025/WP.1.

² The rolling text was recirculated on 20 August, to include a few technical corrections on behalf of the Chairperson.

retain “*select and engage*” as the critical functions of LAWS replacing the previous formulation “*identify and/or select, and engage*”. This choice was made with the understanding that identification is typically a precondition for the function of selection. The Chairperson also drew attention to the new language in paragraph 2 of Box I, which aims to clarify the Group’s understanding of the term “*lethal*” in the context of these elements of an instrument. The new language was an attempt to reflect a middle ground between more narrow and broader definitions, which were put forward during the first 2025 session of the Group.

11. On the functions of LAWS, many delegations supported the revised formulations, designating “*select and engage*” as the critical functions. These delegations argued that the “identification” phase is inherently included within the “selection” process, and that the current wording avoids an overly restrictive approach, while minimizing potential loopholes. Conversely, a number of States maintained that “*identify*” is not necessarily encompassed by “*select*”, emphasizing that identification and selection represent two distinct phases in the targeting process. They expressed concern that the current wording could potentially blur the distinction between LAWS, as addressed in the rolling text, and other weapon systems not being considered by the Group.

12. As during previous sessions of the Group,³ delegations engaged in extensive exchanges on the notion of “*lethality*”, and its role in the rolling text. There was general support for paragraph 2 of Box I, which proposed a definition of “*lethality*”, applicable solely to these elements. Delegations in favour of this approach viewed it as a constructive effort to bridge positions between those wanting to retain “*lethal*” as a characteristic of LAWS, and those calling for its deletion. Nonetheless, several delegations reiterated their respective positions on whether the term should be included in the elements.

13. After the first reading of the rolling text was concluded, the Chairperson put forward several new text suggestions for Box I.

14. One proposal reintroduced the function of “*identify*” before “*select and engage*” to characterize LAWS, accompanied by a paragraph clarifying the meaning of identification. This was intended to address different concerns raised by delegations with regard to the scope of the characterization, either being too narrow or too wide.

15. In paragraph 1, a proposal to replace the phrase “*integrated combination*” with “*functionally integrated combination*” received broad support. Delegations welcomed this revision as it clarified that the characterization does not require all components to be physically co-located, while still ensuring that technological elements are meaningfully linked to the weapon system. Also in paragraph 1, there was general agreement to refer to a human “*operator*” rather than a human “*user*”, with delegations noting that “*operator*” better reflects the role of individuals with direct control over the system and aligns more closely with military and legal terminology. In this regard, several delegations underlined the importance of retaining the word “*human*” before “*operator*”.

16. On lethality, the Chairperson suggested to amend the first sentence and retain the second as a standalone paragraph with minor adjustments. Given that the Group’s work concerns *lethal* autonomous weapon systems, it was considered unnecessary to define lethality in terms of causing death, as this causality is broadly understood. The Chairperson explained that this suggestion ensures that other relevant effects, such as injury and damage to objects, remain captured in the characterization.

17. See below the text that was discussed on Friday morning 5 September and that was circulated informally under the sole responsibility of the Chairperson, with the aim of furthering the Group’s discussions on Box I paragraph 1:

³ See “Chair’s summary – First 2024 session of the GGE on LAWS”, CCW/GGE.1/2024/WP.6, para. 7, “Chair’s summary – Second 2024 session of the GGE on LAWS”, CCW/GGE.1/2024/WP.11, para. 10, and “Chair’s summary – First 2025 session of the GGE on LAWS”, CCW/GGE.1/2025/WP.1, para. 12.

1. *A lethal autonomous weapon system can be characterized as a functionally integrated combination of one or more weapons and technological components, that once activated, can identify, select and engage a target, without intervention by a human operator in the execution of these tasks.*
- 1.bis *For these purposes, the identification function can be defined as the process by which a system scans an environment for potential targets and matches a person or object against a pre-determined target profile. The fact that a human operator sets the target(s) that the system is programmed to select and engage, or the parameters that comprise a target profile, does not exclude the system from the characterization.*

B. Box II

18. In Box II, the Chairperson's rolling text (version 12 May 2025 as corrected on 20 August 2025) proposed the following elements:

1. *The right of the parties to an armed conflict to choose methods or means of warfare is not unlimited.*
2. *IHL applies to armed conflict, whether international or non-international, and governs the use of all weapons, means and methods of warfare, those of the past, those of the present and those of the future, and is, consequently, applicable regardless of the technology used.*
3. *IHL applies fully to the development and use of LAWS.*
4. *In cases not covered by the CCW and its annexed Protocols or by other international agreements, the civilian population and the combatants at all times remain under the protection and authority of the principles of international law derived from established custom, from the principles of humanity and from the dictates of public conscience.*
5. *Context-appropriate human judgement and control is needed to ensure the use and effects of LAWS are in compliance with international law, in particular IHL, including the principles and requirements of distinction, proportionality and precautions in attack.*

19. During previous sessions of the Group, most of Box II already enjoyed broad support, as it draws on language from past reports adopted by the Group, the Guiding Principles, and the preamble of the CCW, particularly the first three paragraphs. Some changes were made following requests put forward by delegations during the first 2025 session, including a revision of paragraph 4 to make it less specific to LAWS. The Chair noted that paragraph 5 retained the notion of “*context-appropriate human judgement and control*”, as it represents an effort to bridge divergences with regard to the level of control over LAWS necessary to be able to use them in accordance with international law, in particular IHL.

20. Delegations broadly welcomed paragraphs 1 to 3 and reiterated the importance of referencing existing IHL and previously agreed language. A number of delegations also supported the revised paragraph 4, noting its alignment with the Martens Clause, and the CCW preamble.

21. Most exchanges focused on paragraph 5, particularly on the concept of “*context-appropriate human judgement and control*”. Many delegations expressed support for the term while others voiced reservations, noting that combining “*judgment*” and “*control*” could lead to divergent interpretations and conflate the two notions. Others indicated their support for “*context-appropriate human judgement and control*”, provided that its meaning is clearly defined in the text. Several delegations welcomed a newly submitted working paper by a group of States, which offered concrete elements to develop a shared understanding of the notion.⁴

⁴ See “Working Paper on the ‘human element’”, CCW/GGE.1/2025/WP.4.

C. Box III

22. In Box III, the Chairperson's rolling text (version 12 May 2025 as corrected on 20 August 2025) proposed the following elements:

1. *It is prohibited in all circumstances to use LAWS which are of a nature to cause superfluous injury or unnecessary suffering, which are inherently indiscriminate, or which are otherwise incapable of being used in compliance with IHL.*
2. *LAWS may only be used in accordance with IHL, including the principles and requirements of distinction, proportionality and precautions in attack.*
3. *It is prohibited in all circumstances to make the civilian population as such, individual civilians or civilian objects the object of an attack by LAWS.*
4. *It is prohibited to use LAWS if their effects in attack cannot be anticipated and controlled, as required by IHL in the circumstances of their use.*
5. *The prohibitions set forth in the preceding paragraphs must be taken into account in the design, development, and use of LAWS.*
6. *In order to uphold compliance with IHL, States should ensure context-appropriate human judgement and control in the use of LAWS, through, inter alia, the following measures:*
 - (a) *Ensure the effects of LAWS are adequately predictable, reliable, traceable and explainable to those responsible for their use.*
 - (b) *Ensure that LAWS are operated under a responsible chain of command and control. This includes ensuring assessment of legal obligations and ethical considerations by a human, in particular, with regard to the effects of the selection and engagement functions.*
 - (c) *Ensure that LAWS' mission parameters with regard to the types of targets, duration, geographical scope, and scale of the operation cannot be modified by the system without context-appropriate human judgement and control.*
 - (d) *Control, limit or otherwise restrict the types of targets, duration, geographical scope, and scale of the operation of LAWS, including through, as appropriate*
 - (i) *Ensuring that LAWS can be deactivated in a timely manner and/or incorporate self-destruct, self-deactivation or self-neutralization mechanisms;*
 - (ii) *Limiting the number of engagements that LAWS can undertake autonomously;*
 - (iii) *Limiting the operation of LAWS to a defined perimeter in particular to reduce the likelihood of harm to civilians or damage to civilian objects;*
 - (iv) *Restrict the use of LAWS to objects that are military objectives by nature;*
 - (v) *Limiting real-time machine learning with regard to target selection and engagement functions.*

23. The Chairperson introduced Box III by noting that paragraphs 1 to 5 reaffirm a number of principles agreed within existing IHL, while not reinterpreting existing obligations. Then the Chairperson indicated that paragraph 6 and its subparagraphs aim to clarify the link between IHL and the specific measures designed to ensure compliance with IHL. Paragraph 6 also serves as a way to elaborate the degree of human judgement and control needed to enable compliance with IHL.

24. Many delegations reiterated support for the so-called "two-tier approach", containing both prohibitions and regulations, and underlined that elements in Box III could serve as core components of a possible future instrument.

25. Delegations broadly expressed support for paragraphs 1 to 4, recognizing that they reflect existing obligations under IHL and the Guiding Principles adopted by the Group in 2019. Several delegations proposed textual refinements to enhance clarity and consistency, including merging paragraphs, replacing "controlled" with "limited" in paragraph 4, and

harmonizing the language on prohibitions, as paragraph 2 currently reads more like an obligation.

26. However, paragraph 3 prompted diverging views. While many delegations supported its intent to prohibit attacks by LAWS against civilians and civilian objects, concerns were raised regarding the phrase “*in all circumstances*.” Some delegations were concerned that this would also include civilians directly participating in hostilities. Consequently, several delegations called for alignment with Article 51 of Additional Protocol I to the Geneva Conventions.

27. Several delegations had diverging views on 6A, in particular on whether to use the concepts “*predictable, reliable, traceable and explainable*”. Some delegations argued that these terms are all non-legal terms and that they should be deleted, while others stated they would like to see them retained. Again, others saw merit in retaining a version of “*predictable*” and “*reliable*”, possibly through an alternative wording, and omitting “*traceable*” and “*explainable*” as there is no common understanding on what these mean.

28. Divergent views were also expressed regarding paragraph 6B, particularly concerning the reference to “*ethical considerations*” as factors to be assessed by a human. Many delegations emphasized that, unlike legal obligations, ethical considerations do not have a legal basis and therefore should not be included or not be presented on an equal footing. However, other delegations took the floor to support the inclusion of ethical considerations, arguing that LAWS raise new ethical questions that warrant reflection in the rolling text.

29. Delegations engaged in detailed exchanges on paragraph 6D and its subparagraphs, which propose potential limitations and restrictions for the use of LAWS. Several delegations argued that subparagraph 6D(ii), concerning the limitation on the number of autonomous engagements, is incompatible with existing IHL. However, several other delegations supported its retention, viewing it as an important safeguard to reduce risks. Regarding paragraph 6D(iv), numerous delegations expressed concern that the phrase “*by nature*” introduces a narrower definition of military objectives than found in other IHL instruments and considered it overly restrictive. Regarding 6D(v), which invites limitation on real-time machine learning in target selection and engagement functions, several delegations called for its deletion, while others advocated for measures to mitigate associated risks.

D. Box IV

30. In Box IV, the Chairperson’s rolling text (version 12 May 2025 as corrected on 20 August 2025) proposed the following elements:

Prior to potential deployment and as applicable throughout the entire life cycle of LAWS, States should:

1. *Conduct legal reviews to determine, in accordance with their obligations under international law, in the study, development, acquisition, or adoption of LAWS, whether its deployment would, in some or all circumstances, be prohibited by international law. In this context, the voluntary exchange of relevant practices between States is encouraged, bearing in mind national security considerations or commercial restrictions on proprietary information.*
2. *Ensure there is context-appropriate human judgement and control across the LAWS lifecycle.*
3. *Ensure that the capabilities and limitations of LAWS, in its expected use, and its anticipated effects in different circumstances, are understood.*
4. *Ensure that any further development or modification to existing LAWS that have an impact on their target selection and engagement functions or on its anticipated effects, are reviewed to ensure compliance with IHL.*
5. *Conduct rigorous testing and evaluation, including realistic simulations of its use in operational environments, to enable a human user to have a reliable expectation of how LAWS will perform in the anticipated circumstances of its use.*
6. *Implement measures to detect, correct or mitigate, as much as possible, unintended bias in artificial intelligence capabilities, including bias in data sets and AI models.*
7. *Implement measures to detect, correct or mitigate, as much as possible, automation bias.*

8. *States should ensure appropriate guidance, training and instructions for those in the responsible chain of command and human users of LAWS, in order to provide them with a proper understanding of the capabilities and limitations of the LAWS in the anticipated circumstances of use.*
9. *States undertake not to manufacture, otherwise acquire, stockpile, or transfer LAWS that cannot be used in compliance with IHL.*

31. The Chairperson explained that Box IV had been revised to clarify the obligation of States to conduct legal reviews in accordance with applicable international law, as reflected in paragraph 1. In response to concerns raised during the March session regarding bias, the Chairperson introduced a distinction between unintended bias in AI capabilities (paragraph 6) and automation bias affecting human operators (paragraph 7). Paragraph 8 was updated to emphasize the importance of guidance, training, and instructions for those in the responsible chain of command and control, including direct users of LAWS. A new paragraph (paragraph 9) was added to address the broader life cycle of LAWS, reaffirming that systems which cannot be used in compliance with IHL should not be manufactured, acquired, stockpiled, or transferred.

32. Many delegations welcomed the language in Box IV, noting its emphasis on the need for States to conduct legal reviews to ensure that the development and use of LAWS is in compliance with international law, and in particular with IHL.

33. Nearly all delegations expressed support for the paragraphs referring to the obligation of conducting legal reviews, in particular paragraph 1. However, paragraph 4 prompted further discussions, as it highlights the need for additional legal reviews when LAWS are updated and modified. Some delegations suggested qualifying the term “impact” with “*significant*” to avoid requiring a legal review for every minor change. One delegation, subsequently supported by others, proposed introducing “*periodic reviews*” to enable regular assessments of the weapon systems.

34. Regarding the notion of “*context-appropriate human judgement and control*” referenced in paragraph 2, several delegations reiterated their diverse positions expressed during the exchanges on previous Boxes or expressed doubts whether this notion should also be repeated in this Box.

35. In previous sessions of the Group, several delegations called for stronger language on the need to prevent and mitigate biases – particularly gender and racial biases. This time, there was widespread support for the way biases were addressed in the rolling text. Most delegations welcomed the change from “harmful” to “unintended” biases, as reflected in the current version, considering it a more neutral and technically appropriate term. However, some delegations argued that a certain degree of bias is inevitable since it is an intrinsic feature required for making the necessary distinction in target identification.

36. States welcomed the inclusion in paragraph 8 of the rolling text of the requirement to develop adequate guidance, trainings and instructions for those who will operate LAWS.

37. Some delegations welcomed the inclusion of paragraph 9, recognizing its effort to address the full lifecycle of LAWS. In this context, a few delegations recalled Guiding Principle (j),⁵ and emphasized the importance of indicating in the rolling text that the measures outlined do not hamper scientific and technological advancement.

38. As in the previous session of the Group, several delegations requested the inclusion of an additional paragraph to address the need to prevent the proliferation and diversion of LAWS by non-States actors.⁶ In addition, one delegation, supported by others, proposed the inclusion of a new paragraph to reflect security concerns which could affect the functioning of LAWS, such as jamming and spoofing.

⁵ Guiding Principle (j): “Discussions and any potential policy measures taken within the context of the CCW should not hamper progress in or access to peaceful uses of intelligent autonomous technologies.”, Annex IV to CCW/GGE.1/2019/3.

⁶ See “Chair’s summary, First 2025 session of the Group”, CCW/GGE.1/2025/WP.1, paragraph 29.

E. Box V

39. In Box V, the Chairperson's rolling text (version 12 May 2025 as amended on 20 August 2025) proposed the following elements:

1. *IHL imposes obligations on States, parties to armed conflict and individuals, not on machines.*
2. *States, parties to armed conflict, and individuals must at all times remain responsible and accountable in accordance with applicable international law for decisions with regard to LAWS since responsibility and accountability cannot be transferred to machines. This should be considered across the entire life cycle of the weapon system.*
3. *States must ensure individual accountability for the means or methods of warfare involving the use of LAWS in accordance with their obligations under IHL.*
4. *States must ensure accountability across the entire life cycle of LAWS to ensure compliance with applicable international law, including through the operation of such systems within a responsible chain of human command and control.*
5. *To promote human responsibility and accountability in the use of LAWS and to mitigate the risk of unintended engagements, States should provide:*
 - (a) *Readily understandable human-machine interfaces and controls;*
 - (b) *Guidance (e.g., policies, doctrine, and procedures), consistent with applicable IHL, for personnel regarding the proper use of LAWS;*
 - (c) *Training of personnel to understand such guidance and the capabilities and limitations of the LAWS' autonomous functions in the anticipated circumstances of its use; and*
 - (d) *Appropriate rules of engagement or other directives or orders circumscribing the use of the weapon system in military operations, consistent with applicable IHL.*
6. *States must ensure effective domestic mechanisms for the investigation, reporting and redressal of incidents that may involve violations of IHL. These domestic mechanisms should address, where relevant, incidents related to the development and use of LAWS.*
7. *States must take all appropriate steps, including legislative and other measures to prevent and suppress violations of IHL relating to LAWS by persons or on territory under their jurisdiction.*

40. Upon introducing Box V, the Chairperson noted, that compared to the previous version, paragraph 1 includes an overarching principle aligned with Guiding Principle (b)⁷ about IHL obligations on human responsibility and accountability. Some new language was introduced to further specify how human responsibility and accountability can be promoted.

41. Overall, delegations welcomed this Box affirming that accountability and responsibility cannot be transferred to weapon systems. Some delegations suggested that the language could be streamlined, and that some of its paragraphs – given their significance – might be better placed in other boxes of the rolling text. A number of delegations expressed concern over inconsistencies in the terminology used around accountability and called for greater alignment throughout the text.

42. Some delegations observed that Box V does not explicitly reference the notion of international responsibility of States and recommended the inclusion of a dedicated paragraph to address this aspect.

43. Several delegations positively noted that paragraph 5 and its subparagraphs outline useful measures for States to promote responsibility and accountability in the use of LAWS.

⁷ Guiding Principle (b): "Human responsibility for decisions on the use of weapons systems must be retained since accountability cannot be transferred to machines. This should be considered across the entire life cycle of the weapons system", Annex IV to CCW/GGE.1/2019/3.

44. A few delegations expressed opposition to paragraph 6, arguing that matters related to domestic mechanisms fall within national prerogatives and lie outside the mandate of the Group.

45. With respect to paragraph 7, several delegations emphasized that the scope of measures to prevent and suppress violations should not be limited to IHL alone but should encompass other bodies of international law.

F. Other matters

46. A group of 39 High Contracting Parties and three Observer States delivered a joint statement to share their view on the rolling text. The statement voiced support for the efforts of the Chairperson, his team and the Friends of the Chair, while noting that further work is needed to achieve an outcome by consensus. The statement emphasized that the current rolling text contains sufficient substance to address remaining divergences in the framework of a future process beyond the current mandate, while also stressing that these High Contracting Parties are fully prepared to continue working with other delegations to further refine and improve the text, with the fulfilment of the mandate as their constant guiding objective.

III. Way forward

47. During the second 2025 session, the Group completed a thorough reading of the rolling text and engaged in substantive discussions which allowed the Group to identify areas of convergence, to understand where divergences remain, and to consider concrete options for bridging them. The Group also held several additional rounds of exchanges on Box I, following textual suggestions by the Chairperson. These additional discussions deepened the collective understanding of the characterization of LAWS, especially with regard to the critical functions of LAWS. The Chairperson recognized further work is required, particularly in fostering a common understanding of “*context-appropriate human judgement and control*”. As a result, the session was widely regarded as productive, substantive, and constructive, making a valuable contribution toward fulfilling the Group’s mandate.

48. At the closing of the session, the Chairperson thanked all delegations for their active participation, constructive spirit and commitment demonstrated in the pursuit of the Group’s mandate. He informed delegations of his plans to circulate a Chair’s summary reflecting the discussions held during this second session, consistent with previous practice. The Chairperson also expressed his intention to share an updated version of the rolling text, based on the deliberations and proposals put forward during this session.

49. The Chairperson further announced plans to organize informal intersessional consultations to continue substantive exchanges on the elements and to begin preparing for the first 2026 session. These consultations will aim to facilitate progress toward a common understanding on key concepts and focus on a revised rolling text. The Chairperson shared his intention with regard to the handling of the report to be delivered to the Seventh Review Conference of the CCW in 2026. The Chairperson also outlined his plans for the first session in 2026, indicating that discussions will centre on the new version of the rolling text to ensure that the elaboration of a set of elements will remain the primary substantive focus of the Group’s work.

50. The Chairperson urged delegations to remain actively engaged throughout the intersessional period and to maintain a spirit of compromise as the work of the Group continues. He concluded by reminding delegations that the Group has only two remaining sessions to fulfil its mandate before submission of its report to the Seventh CCW Review Conference in 2026.